

Black-legged Kittiwake - 19 January 2000
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2000-64

Rcd 1/29/00 upl

7-0 (A)

Common Name: Black-legged Kittiwake **Scientific Name:** *Rissa tridactyla*
Number of Individuals: 1 **Sex:** ? **Age:** Juvenile
Locality: **Colorado:** John Martin Reservoir, BENT **County:**
Date(s) Seen: 19 January 2000 **Time:** around noon
Reporting Observer: Christopher L. Wood, 3465 S. Otis Court, Lakewood, CO 80227
Other Observers: Brandon K. Percival
Light Conditions: partly cloudy **Optical Equipment:** B&L Elite 15-60x scope
Distance to Bird: 200 meters
Duration of Observation: 20 minutes
Habitat: standing on and flying over ice on west side of large reservoir

Description: Brandon and I were scanning through a large flock of gulls when I noticed a bird slightly smaller than the Ring-billed Gulls with a black bill, short black legs and a dark ear spot. The bird turned and revealed a conspicuous black nuchal collar. After about ten minutes the bird took off, flew around for a couple minutes, and landed in the middle of the flock where we could no longer see it.

The head and underparts were white, except for a dark spot behind the eye. Bare parts were black. A conspicuous wide black nuchal collar extended (in width) from the mantle to the nape. The mantle was roughly the same shade of gray as the Ring-billed Gulls, perhaps slightly paler. A black carpal bar was visible in flight that formed a black "M" with the black outer primaries, broken in the middle by the gray mantle. The inner primaries, primary coverts, much of the secondaries and outer secondary coverts were white. The secondary coverts and bases to the inner secondaries between the carpal bar and white secondaries were the same shade of gray as the mantle. The slightly forked tail was white with a thick black tip.

Vocalizations:
None

Similar Species:
No other gull has black legs, a carpal bar, and an extensive dark half-collar.

Tape recordings / Photos?
None

References:
None

Description from: ____ Contemporaneous notes; __XX__ Later notes; __Memory.

Experience with Species:

Are you Positive of the Identification? Yes.

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